

Q) Do you think that India would have benefitted more? —
If India had joined NPT? —
— Yes.

What would have been the advantage? —

i) Access to technology.

ii) If India had joined NPT, Pakistan will also have joined. that should have been the aim of India vis-a-vis Pakistan.

Aim → Pakistan should not possess Nuclear weapon b/c we have upper hand in Conventional War.

If after joining NPT, Pakistan had tried to develop Nuclear weapon in a Clandestine Manner, Pakistan would have been under sanctions like — Iran.

iii) India should not have been the 1st to acquire Nuclear weapon. India should have let Pakistan be the first. If Pakistan had been the first, India's Nuclear weapon would have ~~also~~ automatically got legitimacy. India could have given the notice and could have come out.

B/c of India's Action, Pakistan's Nuclear weapon get legitimacy. It means a weaker country defeated in Conventional War had justification to possess Nuclear weapon vis-a-vis stronger neighbour.

Whether India became more secure after acquiring the Nuclear Weapon? -

There is both "No" & "Yes". (But still less secure).

Why less secure? -

B/c Nuclear weapon gave rise to ^{Stability - instability} ~~Security - insecurity~~ Paradox. means it ^{may} gave security at broader level. It means it may prevent major war.

However, it may give rise to instability as Countries will go for Proxy wars.

For E.g. :- In Afghanistan, US raised the force of Mujahideens to conduct Proxy wars against Russia.

Similarly, Pakistan has been conducting war of terrorism / Policy of giving thousand cuts under the Security Umbrella of its Nuclear Weapons.

Pakistan reached to a better position in blackmailing India. Hence, in response to Pakistans Proxy Wars like - Attack on Indian Parliament or Mumbai terror attack, India had to be contented with Strategic Patience.

What alternatives India explored to manage Pakistan Challenge? -

i) Indian Armed Forces Conceptualised - "Cold Start Doctrine".

The idea was to bring enemies territories under occupation of Armed Forces in a swift action so that before international Community starts bargaining we have some advantage.

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In response to India's Cold Start, Pakistan started developing the capacity for Counter Force strike (tactical weapons).

ii) Modi Government :-

Context - At the time of Mumbai Terror Attack when BJP was in opposition, they have raised the Bar. it means Strategic Patience was not an option, it means Modi had to respond.

- a) In response to Uri Attack, India went for surgical strike.
- b) Again Pakistan provoked India by Pulwama attack. Hence, India has crossed the line & went for Balakot strike.

- Surgical strike proved to be a better option than Cold Start. No one could object to India's Action aiming to target the terrorist Centuries Sanctuaries.



In a way India was helping Pakistan in a way a state worst affected by terrorism in eliminating terrorism.

What was the outcome of Surgical Strike? -
India could overcome Pakistan's Nuclear Bluff. India
got convinced that Pakistan is not a mad child.
rather they have purposefully built such image.

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Why? -

To blackmail India and International Community.
(Something like Korea).

Still India can't be assured of Complete immunity
from Attack from Pakistan -

Reason:-

i) Pakistan is becoming a failed State & there
is a big question mark on Safety and Security
of Nuclear weapons in Pakistan.

There is a high risk of Proliferation of Nuclear
weapons in the hands of Non-State Actors.

India is under the biggest threat of Nuclear
terrorism.

How to deal with Nuclear Terrorism? -

- No one knows.

* CHINA FACTOR :-

The main reason told by the then Minister of Defence George Fernandez, in a Secret letter to U.S. President was China Factor. India suffered humiliating defeat at the hands of China in 1962. Hence India lost the Security Umbrella of USSR. Hence, considering the security Environment w/c India decided to go Nuclear. It is believed that Nuclear weapons provided deterrence vis-a-vis China. However, there are inconsistencies in the arguments.

- i) Since China had no 1st Use policy, China should not be seen as a Reason. India should have developed its Capacity for Conventional War.
- ii) Even when India acquired Nuclear weapons vis-a-vis China, it is not clear why we adopted No 1st Use.

In fact India's Nuclear Doctrine is not fully in Public. We can assume that NO 1st Use is only against Non-Nuclear Weapon State.

In this sense we do get security vis-a-vis China.

However, it would be a foolish think that China will go for full scale war with India.

Why? -

They don't require to do so. They will use Pakistan against India. In fact China can be considered as major support for Pakistan's Proxy War.

* India on NPT / 3rd Pillar :-

India was not satisfied with the 3rd Pillar.

Why? -

- B/c it was the weakest pillar.

Why? -

- B/c there is no provision for time bound elimination of Nuclear Weapons.

- To end, we can say that we require more critical insights to examine India's decision to stay out of NPT.

Should India join NPT now? -

- Not possible.

- B/c India can join NPT only as a Non-Nuclear Weapon State, NPT can't change for India. If NPT modifies its role for India it will collapse. It will set the wrong example.

It is also not needed b/c Indo-US Civil-Nuclear Agreement remove the dis-advantages w/c India faced into opting out of NPT.

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* CTBT (Comprehensive Test Ban Treaty) -

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CTBT aims at addressing Vertical proliferation besides horizontal proliferation.

How? -

By putting ban on testing. Testing is needed for building Capabilities. CTBT complements PTBT (Partial Test Ban Treaty).

PTBT is not Nuclear Arms Control Agreement, It is a environmental Agreement.

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to prevent pollution as it bans Nuclear testing in Atmosphere & Water. It permits testing Underground.

CTBT if comes into force will prohibit even Underground Testing.

The major Push for CTBT came after the end of Cold War. In 1998 UNGA passed Resolution in its favour. Uptil now there are around 186 countries w/c are signatories to the Treaty.

US has signed the treaty but not ratified it.
India has neither signed nor ratified.

Indias representative at UN Conference on Disarmament,

Arundhati Ghosh made it clear that India will neither sign now nor ever.

Why India didn't sign ? -

- i) It is a discriminatory Treaty.
- ii) It also creates the words of Haves and Have nots.
- iii) It is neither Comprehensive nor Test ban.

Why SO ? -

- B/c P5 countries have developed capacity for Vertical Proliferation even w/o Physical Testing. They can do through simulation.
- India's Position was not just ideological. India had reasons not to sign. -
 - a) India lost the Umbrella of USSR.
 - b) Security Environment may have created the need for Testing. Hence, India wanted to keep the options open.

Should India sign the Treaty now ? -

- Yes,
- No only India should sign, India should provide leadership.

Why ? -

- i) India also has developed Capacity for simulated Testing.
- ii) India is observing the norm even w/o joining the Treaty.
 - a) After ~~1988~~ 1998, we have imposed moratorium on further Testing ourselves.
 - b) India can't do further Testing under Civil Nuclear Deal.

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Benefits:- a) If India signs the treaty, India will get moral highnorm.

b) It will strengthen India's candidature for NSG

NSG -
↓
National
Supplier Group.

What are India's Objection? -

i) India has problem with Entries into Force Clause of CTBT.

As per the Treaty, only when 44 Countries having Capability to make Nuclear weapons will sign the treaty only then it will come into force.

India considers it as Violation of its Sovereignty, i.e. Unnecessary pressure on India.

* FMCT (Fissile Material Cutoff Treaty) :-

It is also a Disarmament Treaty b/c it will stop the production of Fissile Material w/a is used for Nuclear weapon. The treaty is under negotiation for decades but has not moved further b/c of Pakistan's objection. There is a dis-agreement b/w three major countries over the term of the Treaty. (US-India-Pak).

What is Pakistan's PoV? -

Treaty should also provide for destruction of existing Stockpile. However, India and U.S. favours only stopping the Future Production.

Hence, Pakistan has blocked the Treaty & is engaged in Production of Fissile material at a Faster Pace.

There is a lack of consensus over the list of Fissile Materials. U.S. wants to keep certain materials out. For. Eg.:- America..

The material is not used directly for production of Nuclear weapons but they act as a catalyst for increase the Potency.

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